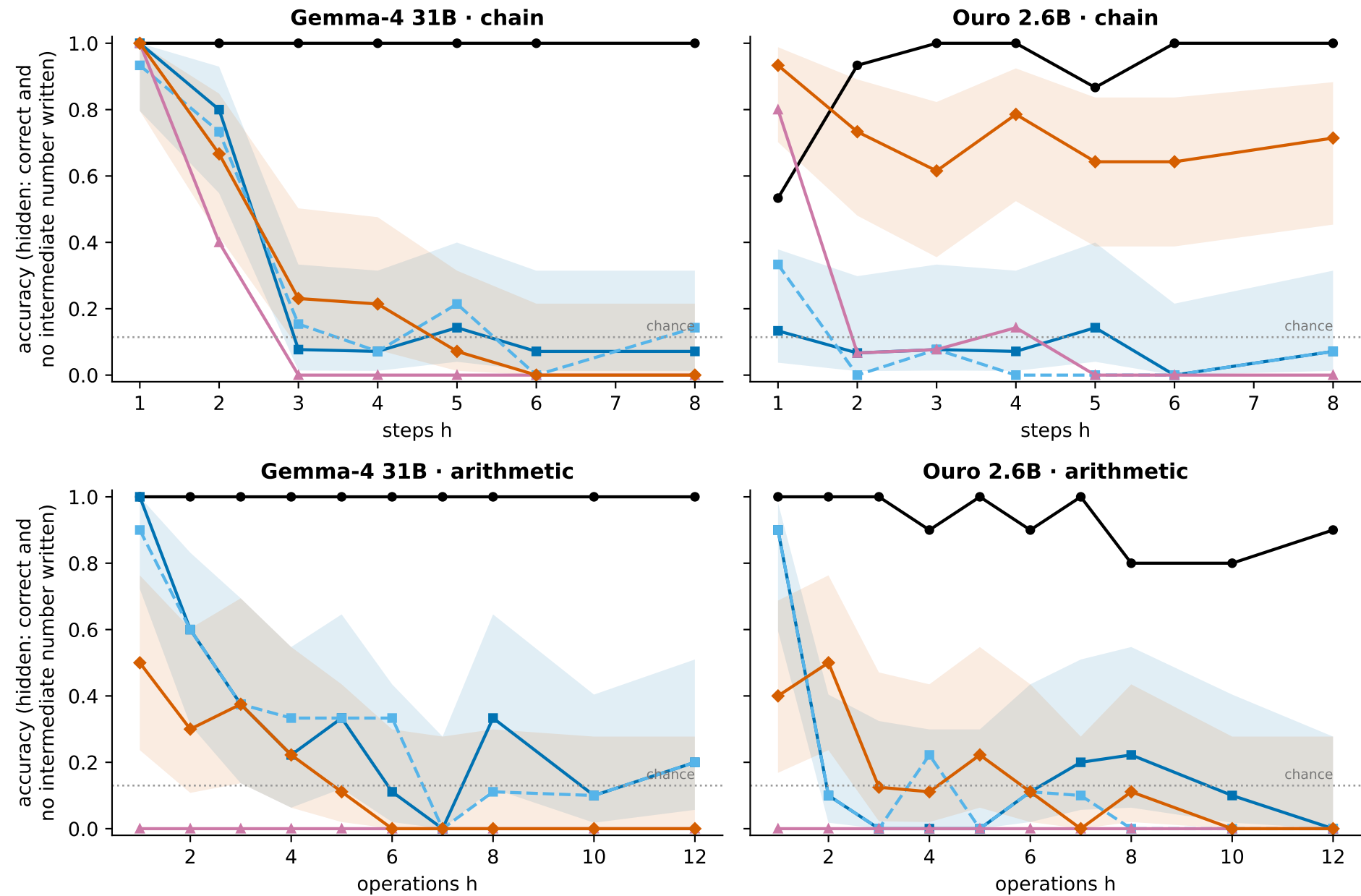


Visible CoT holds up with depth; hidden reasoning falls like no CoT, except Ouro's scratchpad on chain

- visible CoT (no rule)
- no CoT
- no CoT + best dot filler
- hidden: reasoning on, numbers banned
- hidden: scratchpad, numbers banned



~14 dev items per point; shaded: 95% Wilson intervals for no CoT and the hidden scratchpad. Ouro's scratchpad writes the procedure with every number replaced by a placeholder, but still states which branch each step takes (odd/even, above/below). Chain h = 1 has a wording trap that small models fall for.